had entered the building. It was cavernous, like a warehouse. And the floor was covered with bodies. Then, as we watched in horror, one of the bodies rose up on an elbow and a hand reached up—a hand rising out of a sea of bodies, as if it were pleading for help.

There were many other ghastly images: Camp inmates so gaunt and emaciated you wondered how they could possibly still be alive; ditches filled with bodies being bulldozed into the earth; footage of German families brought from nearby villages to see for themselves the unspeakable inhumanity of their countrymen.

One of these films was amazing. The trip to a camp had been ordered by the commander of our troops and as the people left their village, some of them were almost in a festive mood, laughing and enjoying themselves, as if they were on an outing to someplace pleasant they'd never seen before.

Then, you followed the villagers through the camp and the cameramen switched between them and the horrors they were witnessing. Soon their reactions had changed completely: The men began to grow stooped and their faces turned ashen, many of the women began crying, some fainted and others turned away from the camera and began vomiting. They had learned something about their country they had never known before.

When the war ended and Fort Roach closed, I decided to keep a print of one of the films because I remembered that after World War I, there'd been a lot of talk about how Americans had been duped by false propaganda about the enemy, and I thought it might come in handy.

Some years later, a producer and his wife came over for dinner and we started talking about the war and he said, "I really wonder if all that stuff we're hearing about the Germans is true. I don't know if I believe it or not."

"Well, I have a little movie I'd like to show you," I said.